

About IIIF

Canadiana uses the International Image Interoperability Framework (IIIF) to support enhanced sharing of digital objects across platforms, collections, and tools.

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IIIF Overview

The [International Image Interoperability Framework](#) (IIIF, pronounced “triple-eye-eff”) is a set of open standards for sharing images, audiovisual files, and other types of digital objects online. IIIF is used by institutions such as libraries, archives, museums, and scientific institutes to share digital collections.

IIIF is open source, which means that a variety of tools and platforms, such as the Mirador image viewer used by Canadiana, can be built to integrate with IIIF and can be freely used and adapted by other institutions and developers. Additionally, because institutions using IIIF are employing a collective standard to display digital objects, these digital objects can easily be shared between different platforms, different collections, and even different institutions.

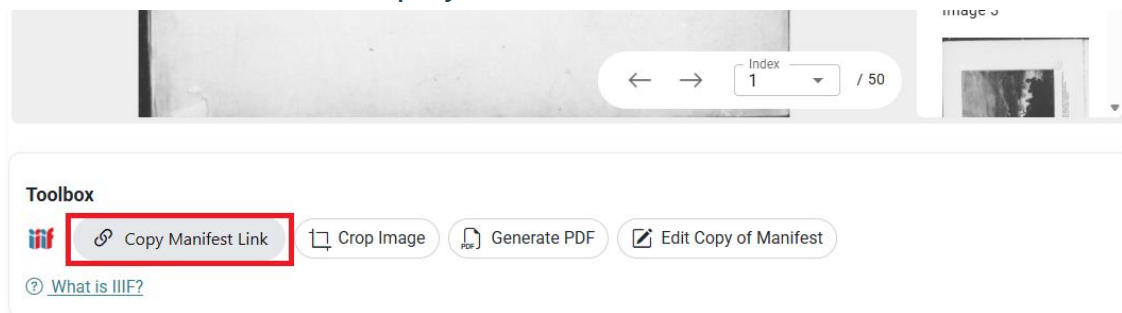
The IIIF Consortium includes members from across the globe. CRKN has been an [Associate Member of IIIF](#) since 2024.

What IIIF Tools are Available on Canadiana?

If you only need to view content on Canadiana, you can simply search and browse the collection as you normally would. However, Canadiana also offers several IIIF-enabled tools in the Toolbox section underneath the image viewer to enhance your research.

- **Copy Manifest Link:** If you would like to use Canadiana content in other IIIF applications, you will need to copy the manifest of that item first. A manifest is an excerpt of JSON code containing all the information of the object, including its content and how it is structured, as well as associated metadata.

On Canadiana, a link to the IIIF manifest for any item can be found in the Toolbox section: Click “Copy Manifest Link” and paste the link into the manifest URL field in any IIIF application. The application will then be able to read the manifest and display the item.



- **Crop Image:** This tool allows you crop and save images from Canadiana items. Click “Crop Image,” then use the pencil icon to draw a rectangle around the part of the image you wish to crop.
- **Generate PDF:** The PDiif tool allows you to generate custom PDFs from Canadiana items. After clicking “Generate PDF,” use the green settings icon to adjust the image size, page range, and optimization settings.
- **Edit Copy of Manifest:** This tool allows you to edit a copy of a Canadiana item’s manifest. Use the various features to annotate images, reorder and delete pages, add images from other resources, and more.

What Other IIIF tools are Available to Use?

There are a wide variety of external IIIF applications available that allow you to view and compare images, build exhibitions, annotate documents, and more. Visit the IIIF website for a list of [popular IIIF tools](#) including image and A/V viewers, digital exhibit platforms, annotation platforms, and manifest editors, as well as useful [IIIF training resources](#).

Where Can I Find Other IIIF-Enabled Collections?

Institutions around the world use IIIF for their digital collections. IIIF maintains a partial list of [participating institutions](#), and you can also keep an eye out for the IIIF logo when viewing material on digital collections websites.

Additionally, the [DetektIIIF browser extension](#) is a downloadable tool that automatically detects IIIF resources in websites.

CRKN has begun a list, maintained on GitHub, of [Canadian institutions using IIIF](#). Do you know of an institution with IIIF-enabled collections, services, or tools that's not listed here? Contact us via the instructions at our GitHub page, or email info@crkn.ca to let us know.

Where Can I Learn More?

For more information, check out the resources below.

- [Get Started – IIIF](#)
- [What is IIIF? – The Courtauld Gallery](#)
- [Introduction à IIIF](#) – French language overview by Biblissima+ (FR available)
- [Module de formation à IIIF](#) – French language training module by Biblissima+ (FR available)
- [Reusing Collections of U of T Items with IIIF](#) – University of Toronto
- [The Open Collections IIIF API](#) – University of British Columbia

Videos

- [IIIF Literacy, from ABC to PhD](#)
- [An Introduction to IIIF](#)
- [Accessible Digitization with the Digirati Manifest Editor](#)

Questions?

Contact CRKN at info@crkn.ca for Canadiana research questions and website troubleshooting.

If you have questions for the broader IIIF community, consider joining the [IIIF Slack workspace](#). A wide variety of channels are available to join, including **#beginners** and **#canada**, where you can ask questions and share updates with Canadian colleagues.